

Table 5.1.7 : Reasons for Migration from District of Previous Residence to District of Usual Residence, 2024

District of Usual Residence	Migrant population	Reason for migration (%)								
		Marriage	Employment/ Searching for job	Education	Accompanied a family member	Returning for permanent residence	Development projects	Resettled after displacement	A disaster/a displaced happened in the prior place	Other
Total	3,036,198	41.8	17.5	6.6	16.6	10.3	1.3	2.4	1.4	2.1
Colombo	519,379	25.5	37.8	11.8	17.4	5.4	0.1	0.1	0.4	1.4
Gampaha	524,737	34.9	26.1	4.3	19.0	12.8	0.2	0.2	0.6	1.8
Kalutara	192,833	43.0	11.3	3.4	17.3	19.7	0.1	0.5	1.1	3.6
Kandy	172,489	50.5	9.7	10.7	15.7	10.4	0.1	0.2	0.5	2.1
Matale	82,805	57.3	8.6	3.1	16.2	11.0	0.5	0.5	0.9	1.8
Nuwara Eliya	60,934	59.6	10.2	3.5	16.7	5.6	0.5	1.3	1.4	1.2
Galle	95,154	57.2	10.3	5.8	13.8	8.8	0.0	0.2	0.5	3.3
Matara	95,958	54.8	6.9	8.9	12.3	14.1	0.0	0.2	0.6	2.2
Hambantota	69,567	61.6	7.4	2.3	12.6	9.9	0.9	0.3	0.8	4.3
Jaffna	29,253	11.9	10.7	20.1	12.9	21.4	0.0	21.0	0.6	1.3
Mannar	22,572	15.3	5.3	1.4	12.8	11.3	0.1	48.5	5.0	0.4
Vavuniya	43,046	21.0	11.0	6.0	21.2	6.6	1.7	17.6	14.3	0.7
Mullaitivu	27,573	27.0	11.5	2.3	19.5	8.9	7.0	10.4	12.3	1.1
Kilinochchi	50,544	12.7	6.3	4.8	11.2	6.1	0.4	50.7	7.3	0.4
Batticaloa	20,395	29.6	13.3	26.0	16.2	7.4	0.2	2.4	3.8	1.1
Ampara	76,457	35.1	8.4	8.6	14.4	14.9	14.2	1.1	2.1	1.2
Trincomalee	35,253	39.9	12.8	6.9	23.8	7.2	1.4	4.9	2.1	1.0
Kurunegala	205,372	54.5	10.1	5.8	16.0	9.3	0.3	0.3	0.8	2.9
Puttalam	104,263	41.1	14.9	2.7	17.9	7.0	0.6	7.6	6.2	2.0
Anuradhapura	153,432	45.3	9.3	6.5	19.0	9.5	4.8	1.4	1.5	2.5
Polonnaruwa	96,237	41.6	8.8	2.1	17.8	14.2	11.9	0.7	1.3	1.7
Badulla	74,945	58.8	9.2	8.6	12.5	7.3	0.7	0.2	0.5	2.2
Moneragala	85,183	52.5	12.4	2.4	15.6	12.8	1.3	0.2	0.8	2.0
Ratnapura	95,751	55.4	10.8	5.8	14.7	9.3	0.2	0.2	0.5	3.2
Kegalle	102,066	66.0	6.9	3.8	12.4	7.8	0.0	0.1	0.5	2.5